

∇ Repres. ∇ (nabla) 03 Aug
Gradient Descent is an iterative optimization algorithm used in ML and DL to minimize the Cost Function $J(\theta)$ by finding optimal parameters (weights & biases) of Model.

$$\nabla f(x, y) = \left\langle \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right\rangle$$

$$\nabla f(x, y, z) = \left\langle \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial z} \right\rangle$$

Q $f(x, y) = 2x^2y - 4y^2$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} = 2x^2 - 8y$$

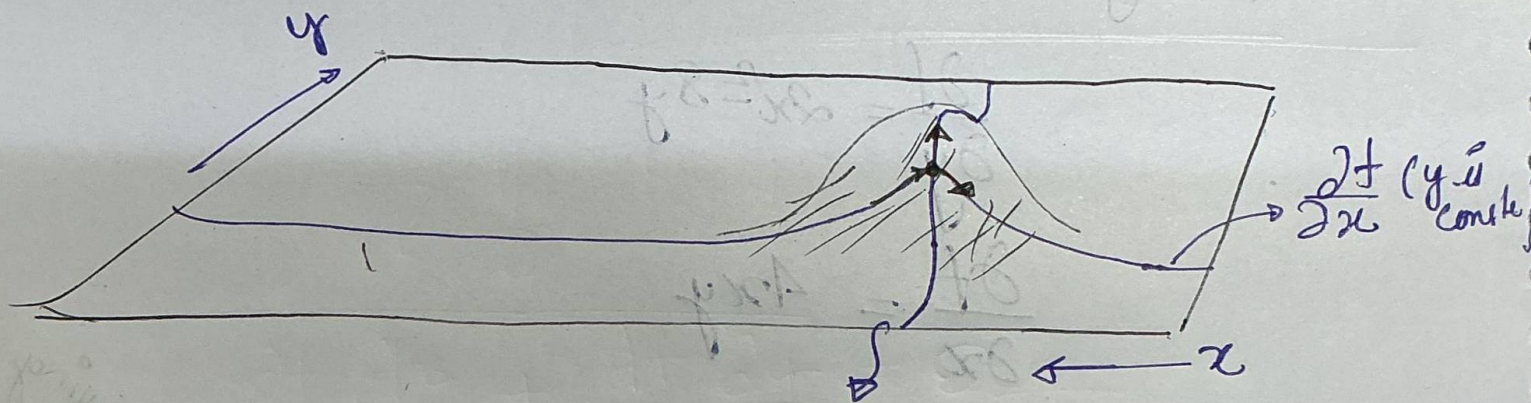
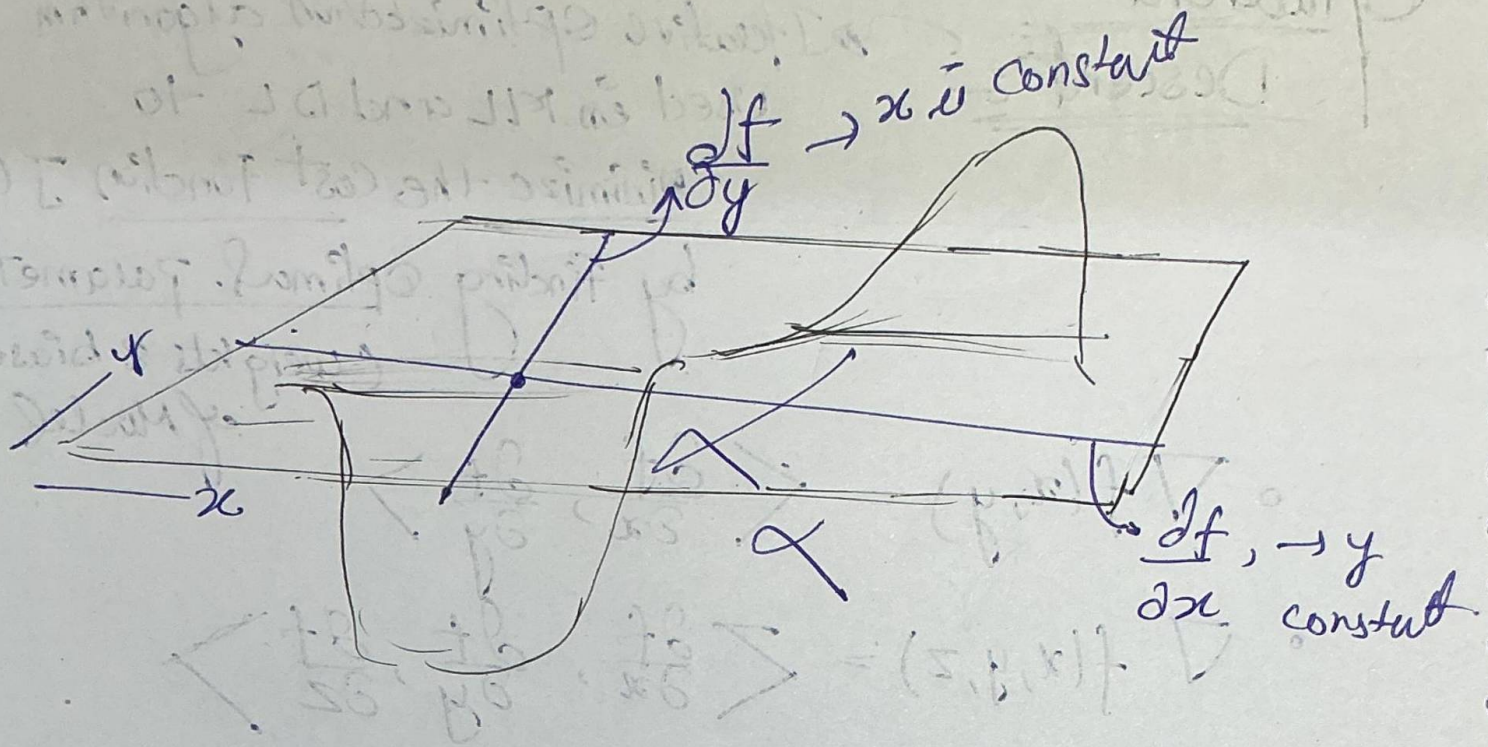
$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} = 4xy$$

$$\nabla f(x, y) = \langle 4xy, 2x^2 - 8y \rangle$$

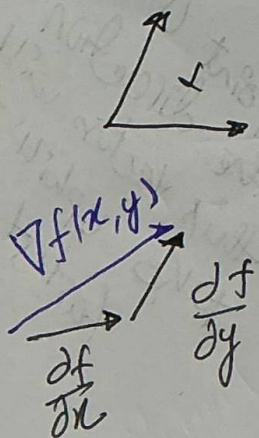
Gradient Vector at point (1, 2),
 $x=1, y=2$

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla f(1, 2) &= \langle 8, -12 \rangle \\ &= \underline{\underline{8\hat{i} + 14\hat{j}}} \end{aligned}$$

At the point (1, 2) moving in the direction of this vector will take uphill the fastest.



$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y} (x \text{ is constant})$
 Slope



$$\nabla f(x, y) = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \\ \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \end{bmatrix}$$

• Direction: The $\nabla f(x, y)$ vector points in the direction of the steepest ascent (fastest way up the hill)

• Magnitude: The length of the vector indicates the steepness of the slope at exact point.

If $\nabla f(x, y) = 0$

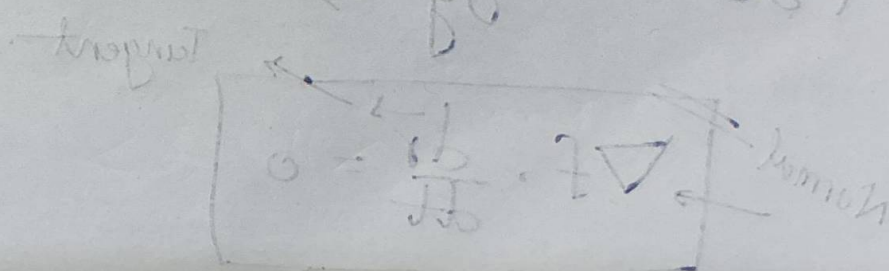
↳ flat peak, valley or saddle point

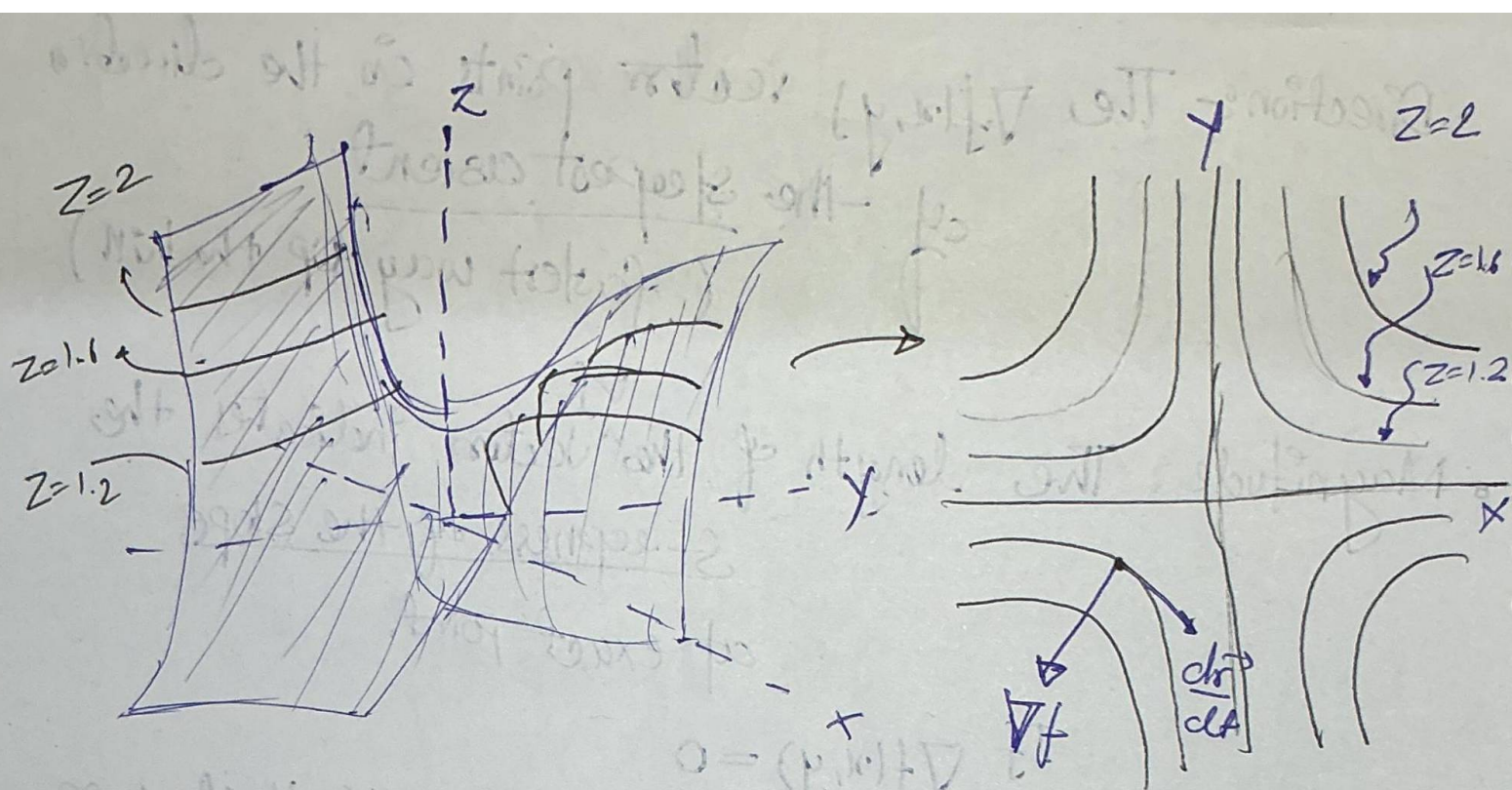
• Perpendicularity:

The gradient vector at any point is always perpendicular to the level curves (contour lines) of the function.

$$0 = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}$$

$$0 = \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right) \cdot \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right)$$





Suppose along a curve $\vec{r}(t) = x(t)\hat{i} + y(t)\hat{j}$

Then $f(x(t), y(t)) = c$

$$\frac{d}{dt} f(x(t), y(t)) = \frac{d}{dt} (c)$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \frac{dx}{dt} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \frac{dy}{dt} = 0$$

$$\left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \hat{j} \right) \cdot \left(\frac{dx}{dt} \hat{i} + \frac{dy}{dt} \hat{j} \right) = 0$$

Normal $\rightarrow$ $\nabla f \cdot \frac{dr}{dt} = 0$ Tangent $\rightarrow$

So, If we change our position vector by tiny fraction $(dx_1, dx_2, \dots, dx_n)$ the total change is given as

$$df = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_1} dx_1 + \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_2} dx_2 + \dots + \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_n} dx_n$$

$$df = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_1} \\ \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_2} \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_n} \end{bmatrix} \cdot \begin{bmatrix} dx_1 \\ dx_2 \\ \vdots \\ dx_n \end{bmatrix}$$

$$df = \underbrace{\nabla f}_{\text{gradient}} \cdot \underbrace{d\vec{u}}_{\text{Tangent vector}}$$

$$df = \|\nabla f\| \|d\vec{u}\| \cos(\theta)$$

For the largest possible increase in our function (df)
 $\downarrow$
 Max $\cos(\theta)$.

So, $\cos\theta = 1 \Rightarrow \boxed{\theta = 0^\circ}$

Thus displacement vector ($d\vec{r}$) must point in exact same direction as gradient vector ∇f .

Therefore the gradient vector directly in the direction of steepest ascent.

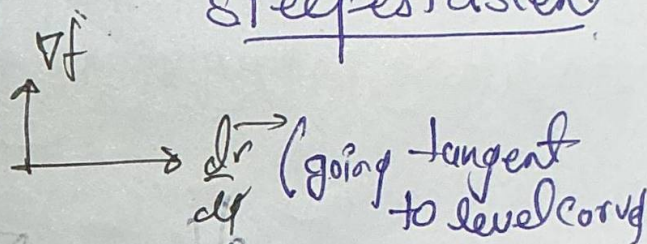
NOTE:

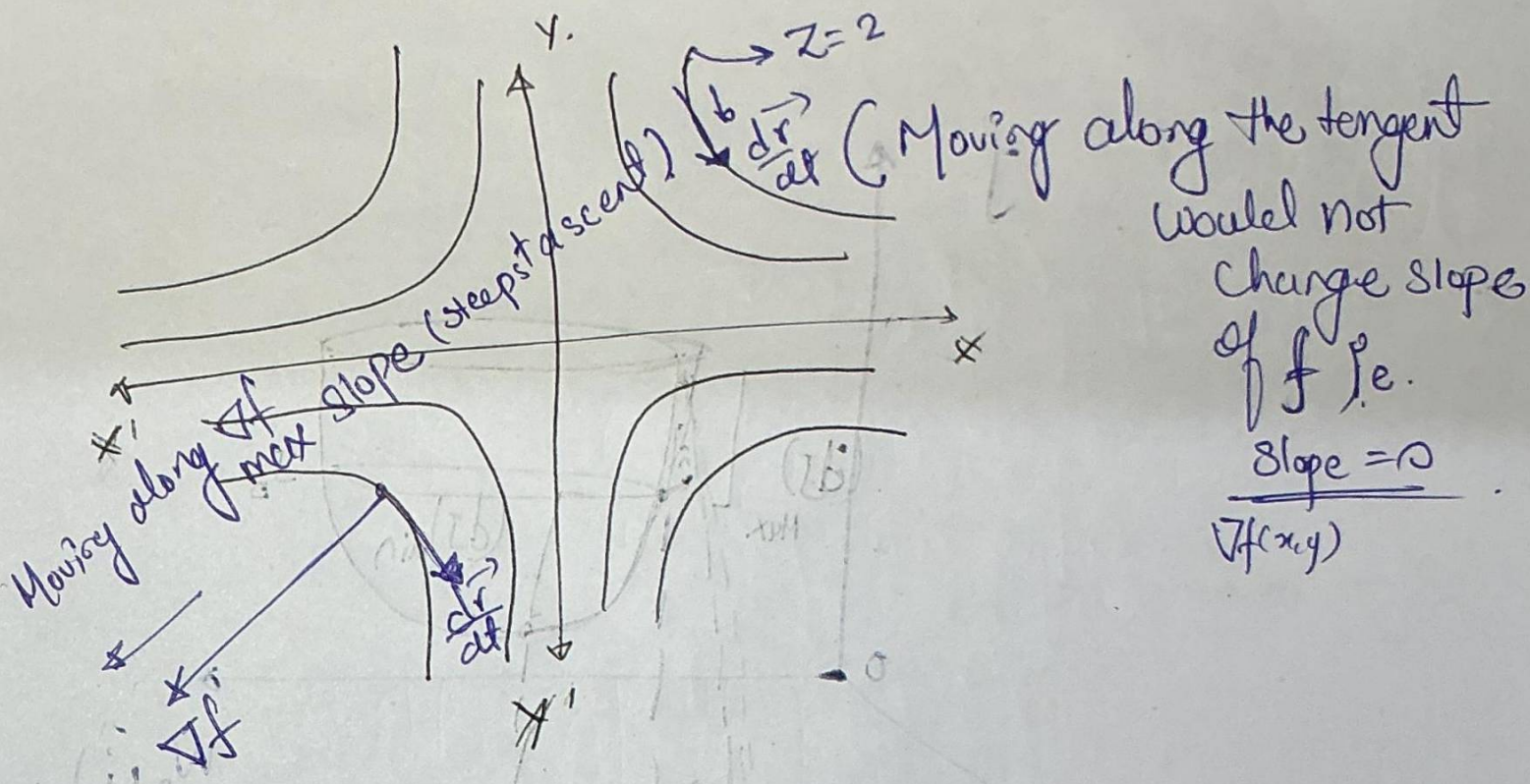
1) Smallest Magnitude when $\theta = \pi/2$

i.e. $\frac{d\vec{r}}{dt}$ is direction of minimum slope

2) Largest magnitude when $\theta = 0^\circ$

i.e. ∇f is direction of maximum slope





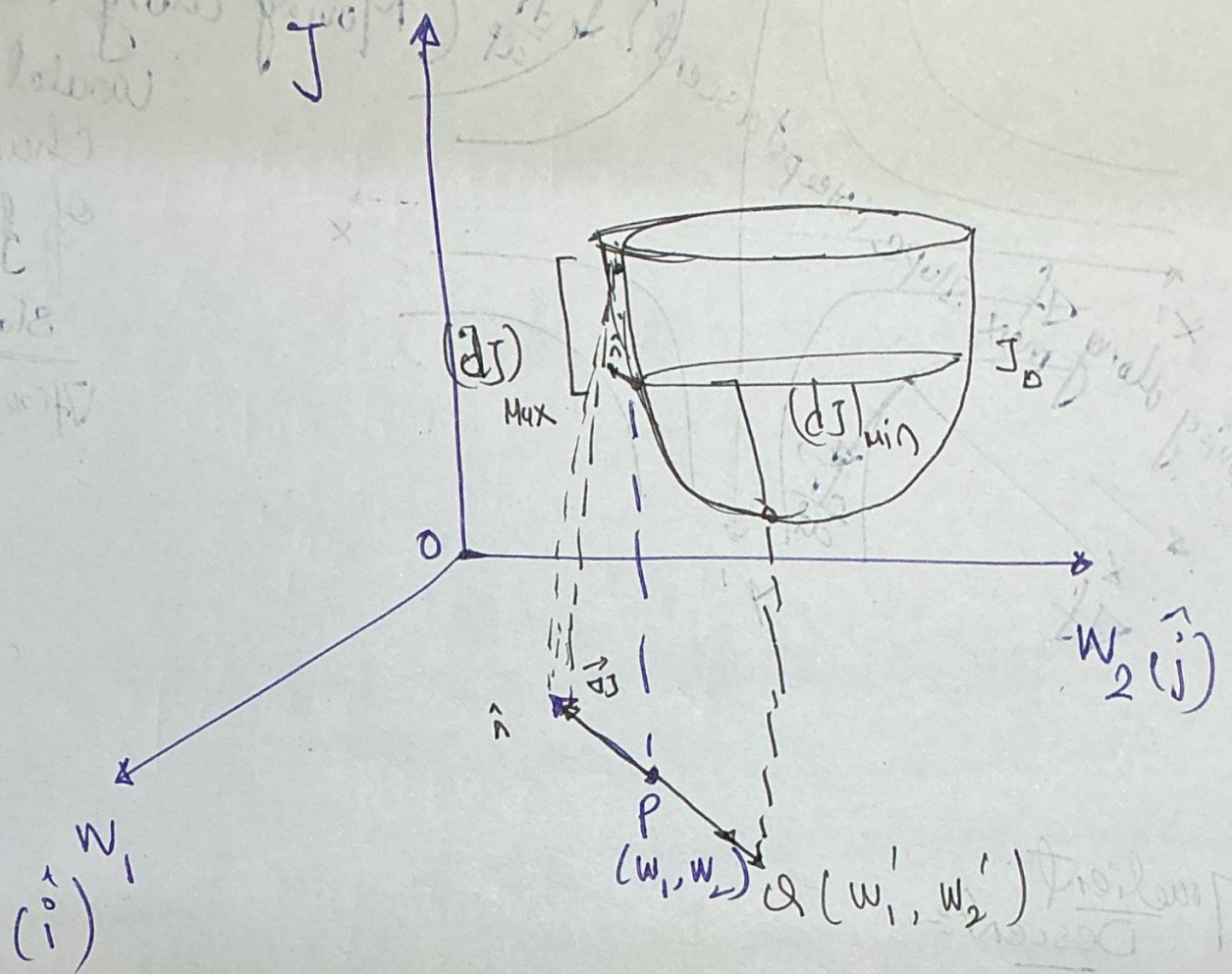
Gradient Descent

$$J \equiv f(w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n)$$

Suppose $J = f(w_1, w_2) \rightarrow$

To minimize the Cost function J

we have to find appropriate values of w_1 and w_2 .



Now we know about directional derivative.
 $(df = \vec{\nabla} f \cdot d\vec{u})$

$$dJ = \vec{\nabla} J \cdot \hat{n} \quad \text{--- (i)}$$

$$dJ = \|\nabla J\| \|\hat{n}\| \cos\theta \quad \text{if } \theta = 0^\circ \Rightarrow \cos\theta = 1 \Rightarrow \text{Max}$$

$\vec{dJ}(\text{Max})$

$$\vec{\nabla} J = \frac{\partial J}{\partial w_1} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial J}{\partial w_2} \hat{j}$$

$$\vec{OQ} = \vec{OP} + P\vec{Q}$$

$$r = |\vec{r}|$$

$$\vec{OP} = w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}$$

$$\vec{OQ} = (w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}) + P\vec{Q}$$

$$\therefore P\vec{Q} = \underbrace{\left(-\frac{\vec{\nabla} J}{|\nabla J|} \right)}_{\text{unit vector along } P\vec{Q}} \cdot |P\vec{Q}|$$

$$\therefore \vec{OQ} = w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}$$

so,

$$(w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}) = (w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}) - \frac{\vec{\nabla} J}{|\nabla J|} \delta$$

as PQ is small $\rightarrow \delta$

$$(w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}) = (w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}) - \underbrace{\left(\frac{\delta}{|\nabla J|} \right)}_{\propto \text{learning rate}} \left(\frac{\partial J}{\partial w_1} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial J}{\partial w_2} \hat{j} \right)$$

$$(w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}) = (w_1 \hat{i} + w_2 \hat{j}) - \alpha \left(\frac{\partial J}{\partial w_1} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial J}{\partial w_2} \hat{j} \right)$$

so,

$$w_1' = w_1 - \alpha \frac{\partial J}{\partial w_1}$$

$$w_2' = w_2 - \alpha \frac{\partial J}{\partial w_2}$$

or

$$w := w - \alpha \frac{\partial J}{\partial w}$$

Types of GDs

① Batch Gradient Descent

Calculates the gradient of the loss function across entire training dataset before making a single parameter update.

- If dataset contains N samples, it computes the avg gradient across all N samples to complete exactly one step.



- The trajectory is exceptionally smooth, stable, and direct. Because it uses all data, it always moves the exact direction of steepest descent.

- Pros:-
- 1) Highly Stable Convergence
 - 2) guaranteed to converge to global min for convex function

- Cons:-
- 1) Computationally expensive and slow for large dataset
 - 2) It requires loading the entire dataset into computer memory (RAM)
↓
Impossible for Massive data.

Pseudocode:-

Inputs:-

- X : Training features (Matrix size $N \times M$)
- y : True label (vector size $(N,)$)
- α : Learning rate or Stepsize
- max-epochs: Total No. of passes over data
- tol: Stopping Condition for early exit.

Output:-

- θ : Optimized parameters (weights & bias)

Procedure:

1. Initialize theta randomly or with zero.

2. For epoch = 1 To Max_epochs Do:

a) Calculate Predictions:

$$y_{\text{pred}} = \text{Model_func}(x, \text{theta})$$

b) Compute loss (e.g. MSE)

$$\text{current_loss} = \text{Compute_loss}(y, y_{\text{pred}})$$

c.) Compute True Gradient across ALL N Samples:

$$\text{gradient} = \left(\frac{1}{N}\right) * X^T * (y_{\text{pred}} - y)$$

d.) Check Convergence

If $\text{magnitude}(\text{gradient}) < \text{tol}$ Then:

Break (Stop training, min error)

e. Update parameters (Take one step downhill)

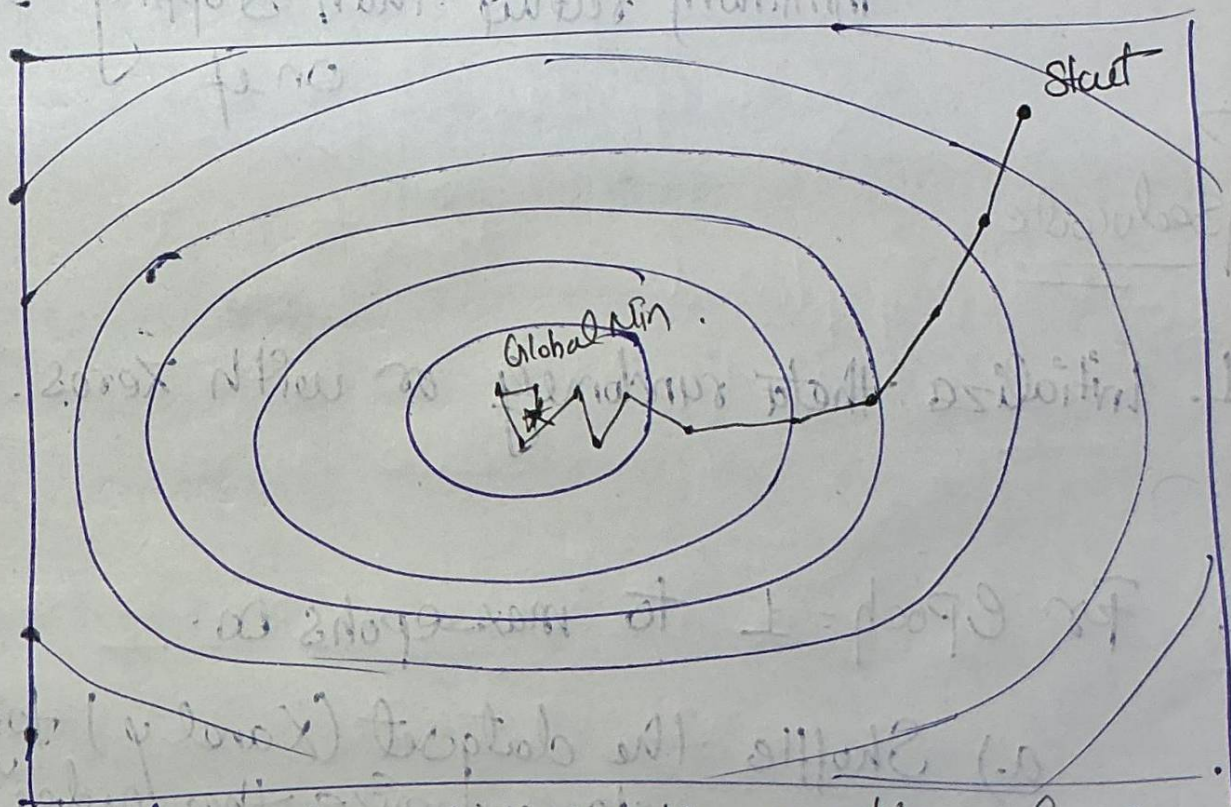
$$\text{theta} = \text{theta} - (\alpha * \text{gradient})$$

3. Return theta.

② Stochastic Gradient Descent (SGD)

Updates Model parameters sequentially after analyzing Just one random training sample.

- For every individual row of data, gradient is calculated and a parameter step is taken immediately.
For N Sample $\rightarrow N$ updates in Parameters.



The path looks highly chaotic, erratic and noisy.

Because individual data points have unique noise, step will often jump sideways or even uphill. However, the overall avg. trend still migrates downwards.

Pros:-

- 1) Extremely fast per step and require almost zero memory.
- 2) The chaotic jumping can actually help algo bounce out of bad local minima or flat plateaus.

Cons:-

- 1) It never truly settle down.
- 2) Even when it finds the absolute bottom, the inherent noise causes it to perpetually bounce around the minimum rather than stopping exactly on it.

Pseudocode.

1. Initialize theta randomly or with zeros.
2. For Epoch = 1 to max-epochs do.
 - a.) Shuffle the dataset (X and y) together to randomize the order.

b. For each individual sample i from
1 To N Do:

i. Calculate Prediction for just this
One Sample

$$y_{\text{pred}_i} = \text{Model function}(x[i], \theta)$$

ii. Compute the gradient for just this one
Sample:

$$\text{gradient}_i = x[i] * (y_{\text{pred}_i} - y[i])$$

iii. update Parameters immediately
 $\theta = \theta - (\alpha * \text{gradient}_i)$

3. RETURN θ .

③ Mini-Batch Gradient Descent. (Industry Standard)

Used in modern deep learning and neural networks.

↳ It splits the data into small, fixed-size groups called "batches"

- Typically batch sizes range from 32 to 512 samples.
also computes the avg gradient for one batch

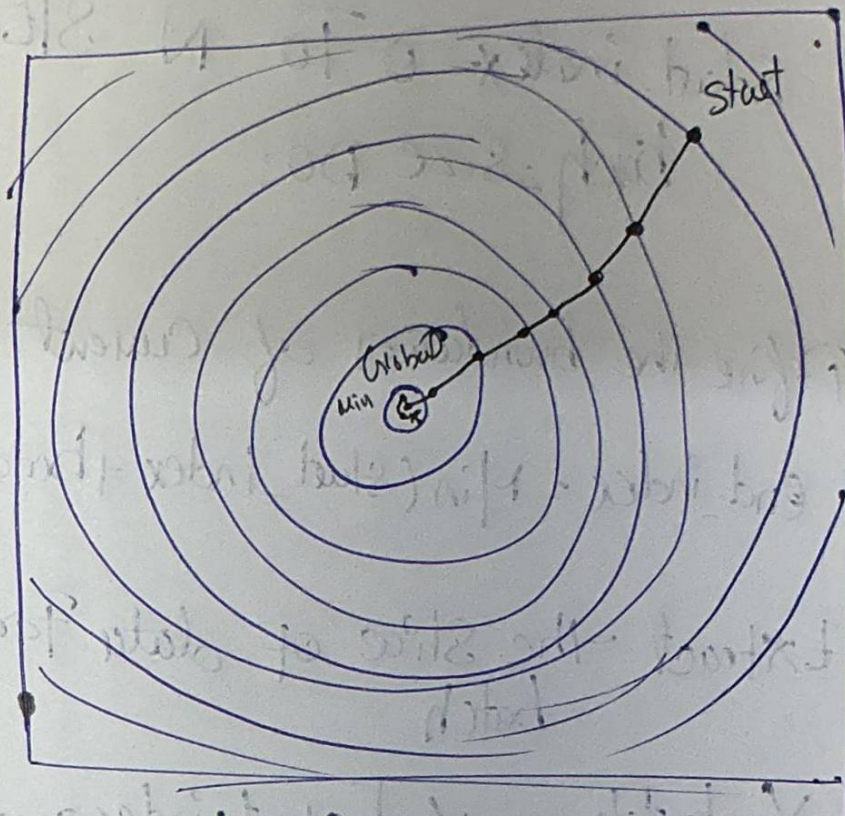
↓
Updates the parameters

↓
Moves to next batch.

Pros:- 1) Highly optimized for Hardware

2) GPUs are best to calculate matrix operation parallelly.

Cons:- 1) Introduces a new hyperparameter that must be tuned manually. (Batch size)



If strikes a perfect balance. The trajectory is relatively smooth and efficient, but retains a tiny bit of healthy oscillation to escape shallow structural traps.

Pseudocode:

1. Initialize θ

2. For epoch = 1 to Max epoch. Do:

a.) Shuffle the dataset (x only)

b) For $\text{start_index} = 0$ To N STEP batch_size DO:

i) Define the boundaries of current min-batch

$$\text{end_index} = \text{Min}(\text{start_index} + \text{batch_size}, N)$$

ii) Extract the slice of data for this batch

$$X_{\text{batch}} = X[\text{start_index} : \text{end_index}]$$

$$Y_{\text{batch}} = Y[\text{start_index} : \text{end_index}]$$

$$K \doteq \text{No. of elements in this batch} (\text{end_index} - \text{start_index})$$

iii) Calculate Predictions for this batch

$$Y_{\text{Predict_batch}} = \text{Model_fun}(X_{\text{batch}}, \theta)$$

iv) Compute the avg Grad Gradient across this batch:

$$\text{gradient_batch} = \left(\frac{1}{K}\right) * (X_{\text{batch}})^T * (Y_{\text{Pred}} - Y_{\text{batch}})$$

N) Update parameters

$$\theta = \theta - \alpha * \text{gradient_batch}$$

3. RETURN θ .

update $(N / \text{batch_size})$ per epoch.